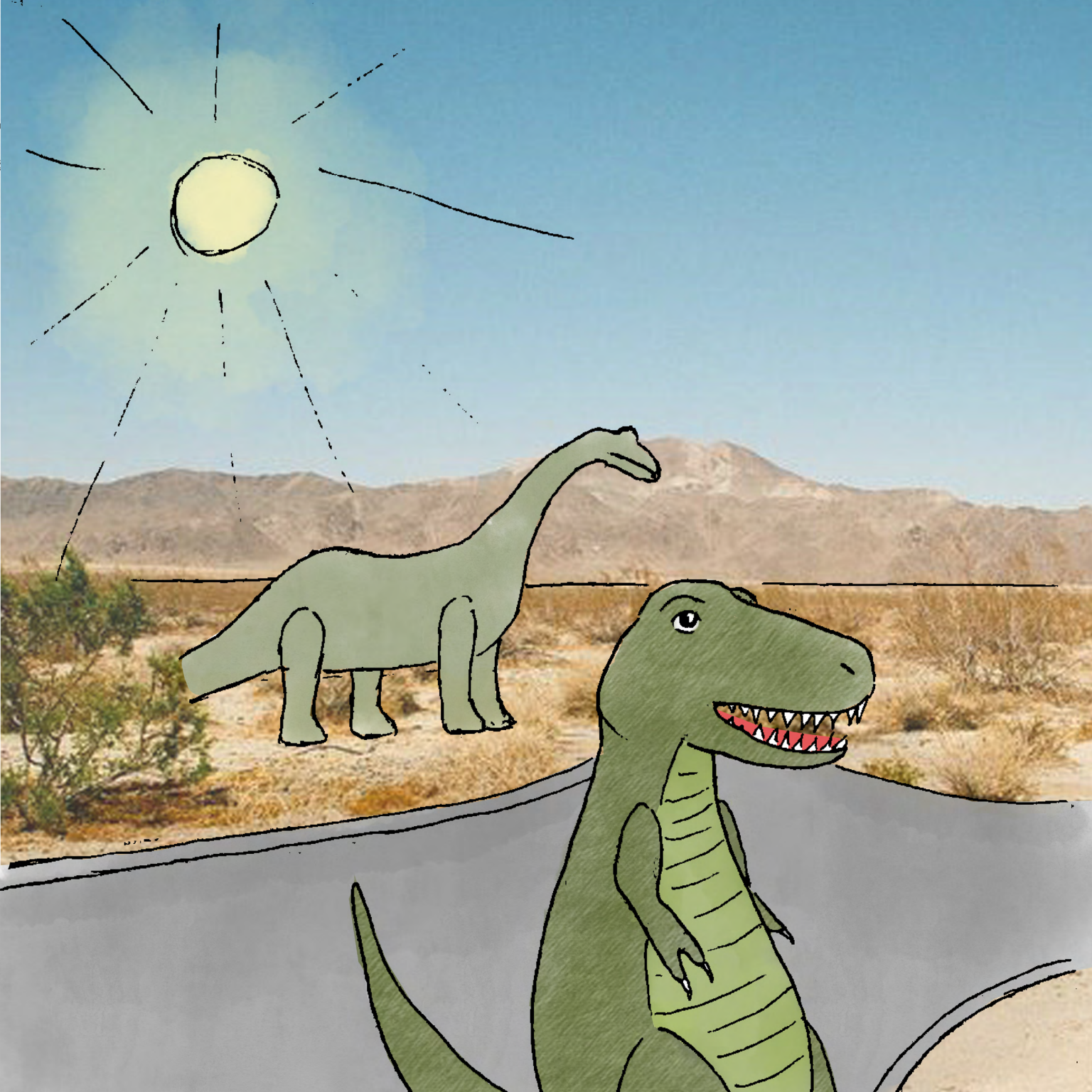


THE LAST DINOSAUR



FOR AUDREY AND HEKLA



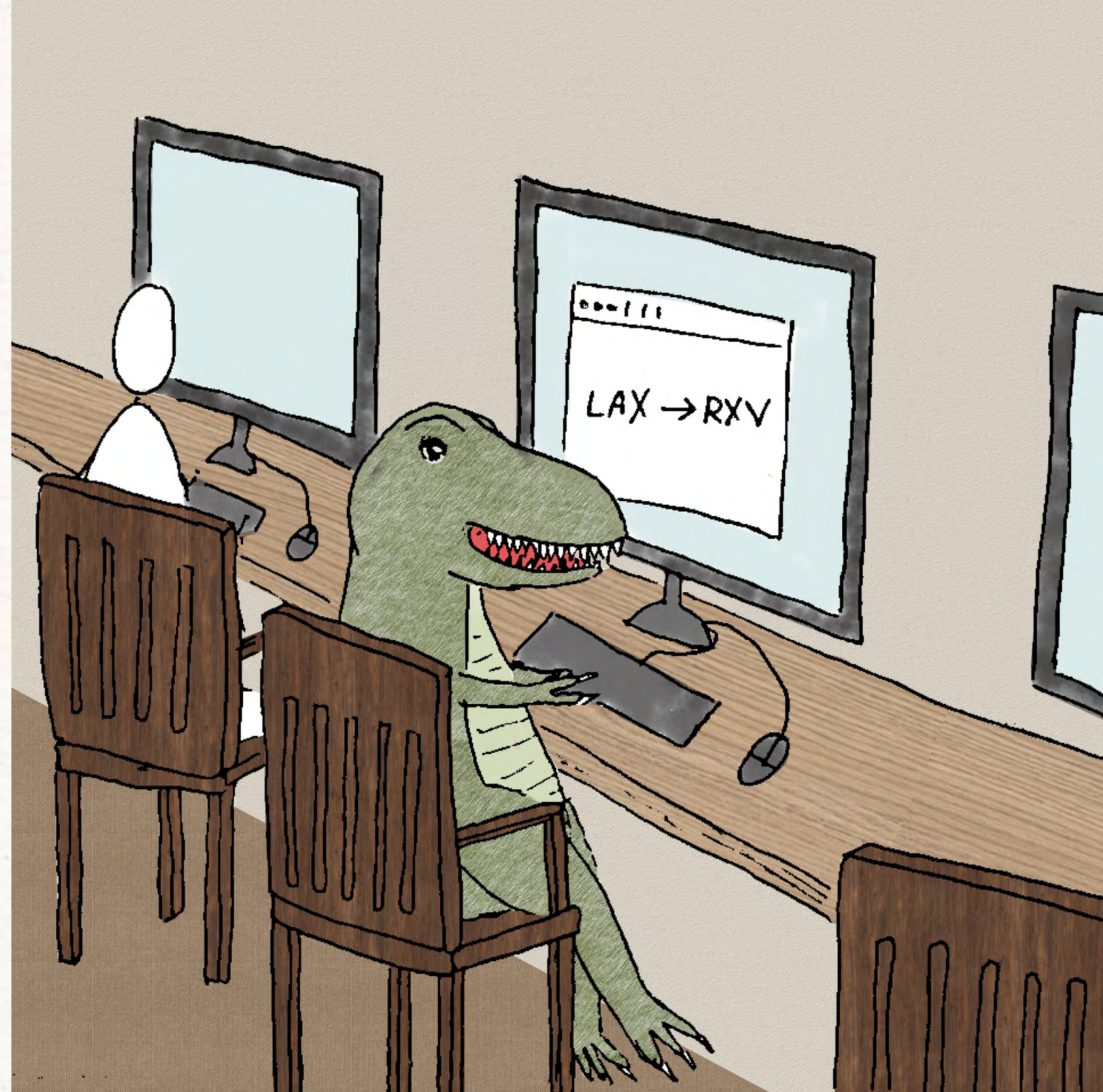
On a sunny afternoon, scorched by the desert sun, Prumpulina left the comfort of her mama's womb and entered the world. Her mama always warned her that in the real world she would be the last living dinosaur on earth and wanted to shield her from a life of loneliness.

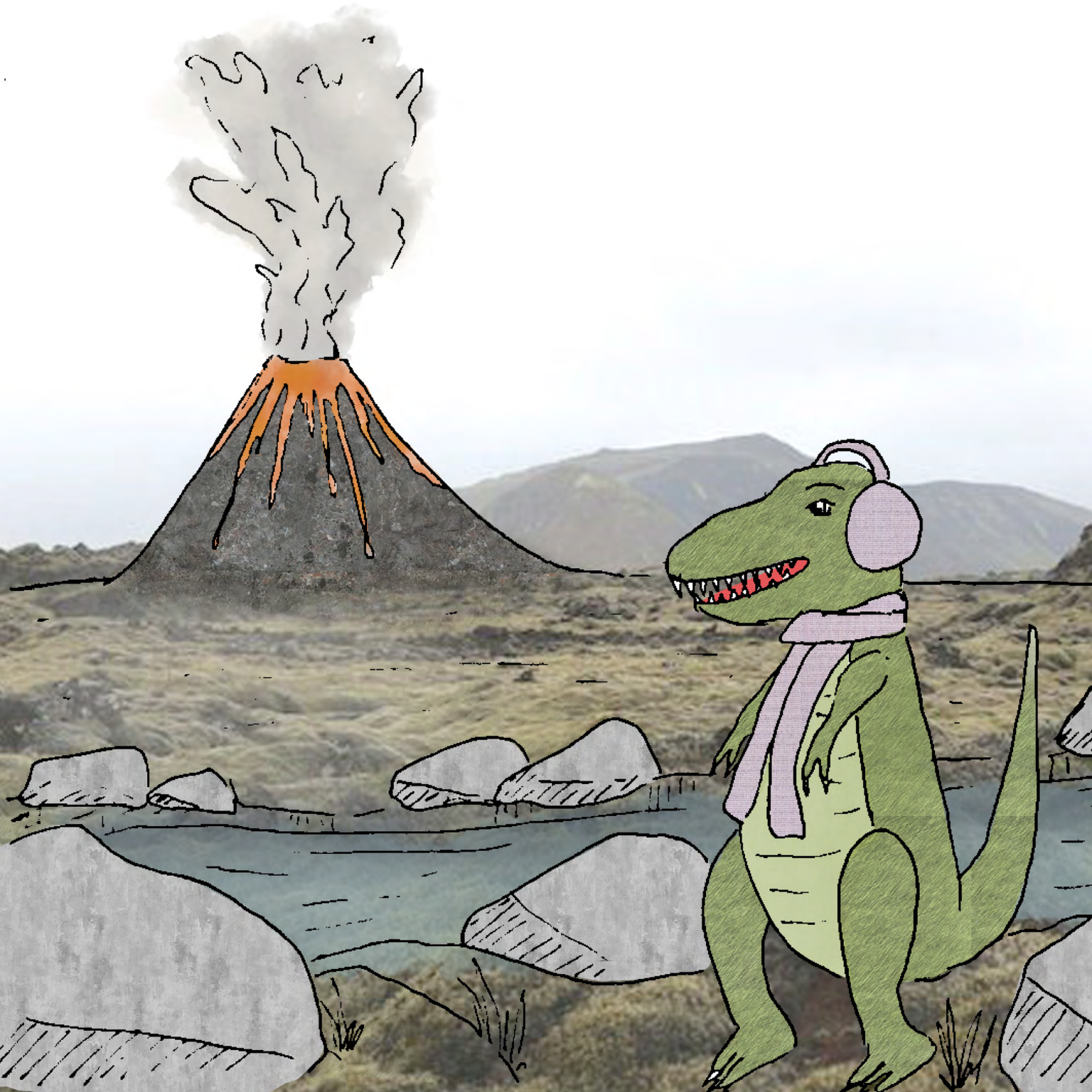
After experiencing her first glimpses of life in the Cabazon dinosaur creationist museum parking lot, she had hope that her mama was wrong.

And she had to prove her wrong.

She knew if she wanted to learn more about her kin, she needed to leave the comforts of the desert. She made her way to the local desert library, using their computer to randomly select a destination that she hoped would help connect her with other dinosaurs.

Iceland stood out to her because it sounded like the opposite of the hot, Mojave desert she was born into all alone. Maybe there she would find other dinos.



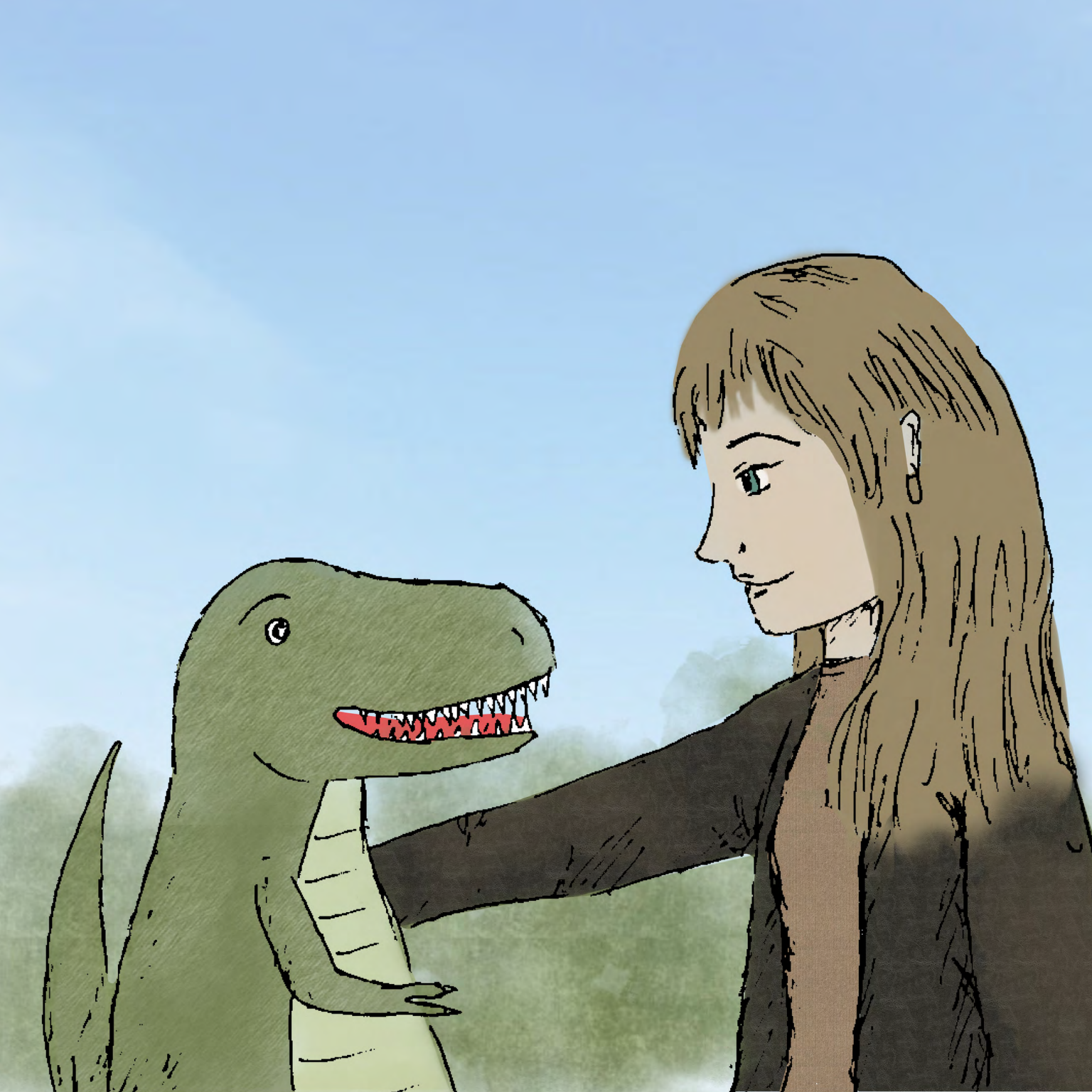


Her flight to Reykjavik departed the next morning. When she arrived, she was in awe at the landscape. It reminded her a lot of the desert she called home, but much colder. This gave her hope of finding other dinos.

She traveled to the university of Iceland in hopes of finding a scholar who would know anything about dinosaurs. She quickly became overwhelmed by all the students who seemed to be too busy with their studies to talk to her.

Feeling beaten down and ready to give up, Prumpi sat and thought of what to do next. A student walked up to her and asked her what's wrong.

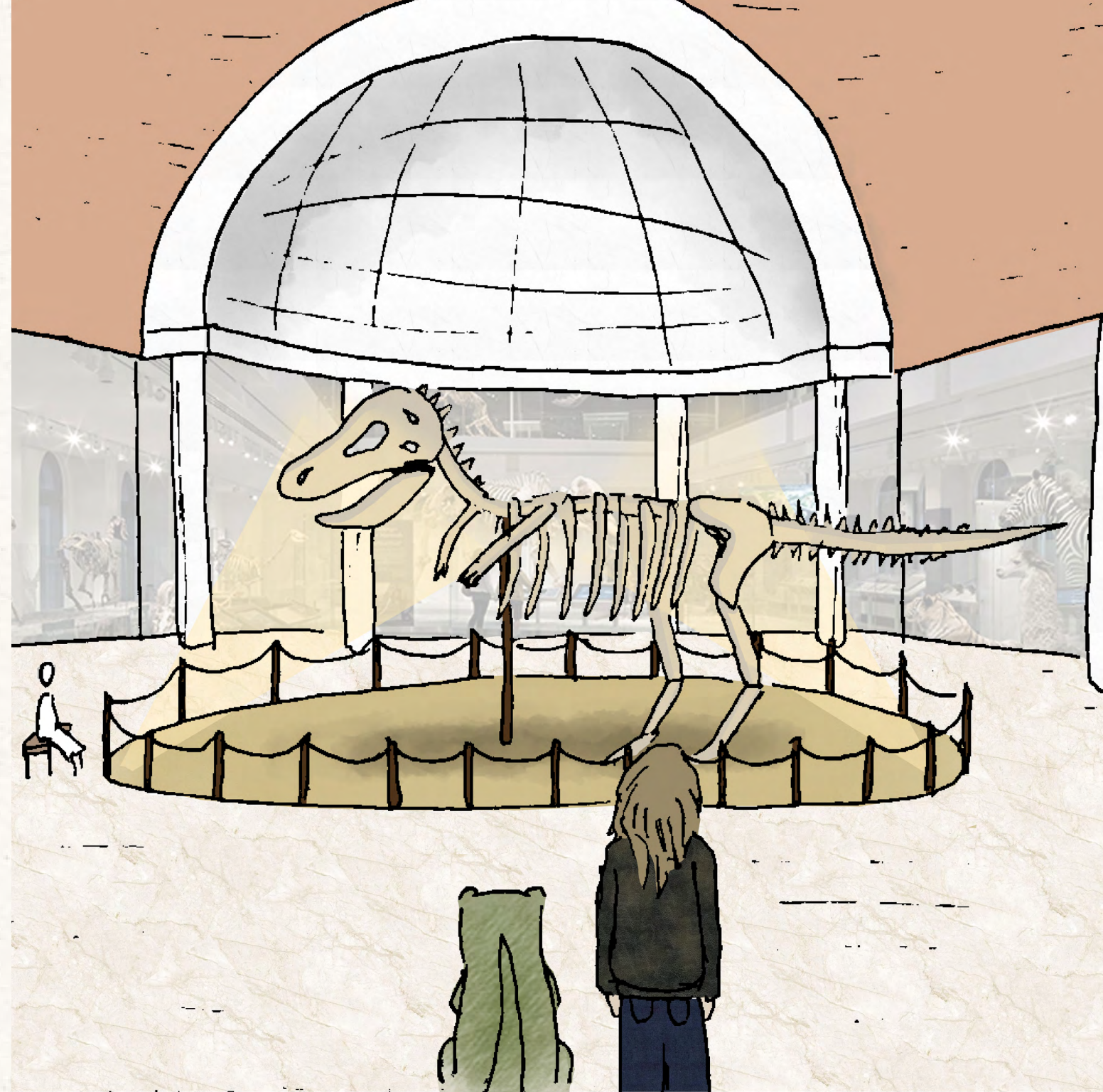




Prumpi explains her situation and the student, who's name she quickly learns is Hekla, tells her that there are no dinosaurs in Iceland, but she wants to help. She suggests that maybe if she was able to connect with her ancestors, she would be able to connect with other living dinos.

She'd heard that there were dinosaur bones at the Smithsonian in Washington DC, and being the largest museum in the United States, she's sure if other dinos are out there they would be visiting too.

At the Smithsonian, Prumpi laid eyes on the bones of her ancestors for the first time. She felt a strong connection to the dinosaurs that came before her, but also was left with a feeling of emptiness. Where were all the other living dinosaurs?





Prumpi and Hekla were brainstorming what they could do next when a girl sitting on a bench, knitting what appeared to be a sweater, perked her head up and intervened.

She introduced herself as Audrey and tells Hekla and Prumpi that she's heard there are more recent fossils at the La Brea Tar Pits in Los Angeles. She's not sure if there would be any dinosaurs, but suggests it could be worth a try.

They departed to Los Angeles that night, arriving the next morning. They found themselves at Union Station, confused as to how to navigate the city. Audrey asks a girl walking by for directions to La Brea Tar Pits, and they end up chatting for a while. She introduces herself as Madeline and ultimately offers to give them a ride over there because she's interested in joining as well.





At the tar pits, Prumpi was hoping to see other living dinosaurs or at least younger dinosaur bones. She quickly learned she would find neither there. Maybe her mama was right; she really was the last living dinosaur. All she wanted now is to be within the comforts of the desert she grew up in. With Hekla, Audrey and Madeline by her side, she made her way back to her mama.

Although the last few days were an emotional rollercoaster, the journey back to the desert was full of laughter and love. She arrived back to the desert with a new mindset: her mama was right, she is the last living dinosaur, but she was wrong that Prumpi would be alone in the world.

In her quest to find her kin, she found three new adopted family figures who love and cherish her no matter what.

